



unfortunately. For me, it's very good in one way — my capacity to improvise is now incredible. But I think India needs to solve this problem. When you arrive in India, you need to know everything. For example, this year, there was uncertainty over when the I-League would start. But this shouldn't happen. You need to know everything beforehand because preparation is very important.

I remember my first year in 2020

— I was in quarantine in my room, and they said the ISL would start in two weeks. Then they said, "No, it starts in three weeks." It's not the same. The difference between two weeks and three weeks is the [duration in] pre-season. A single week of pre-season can be very important. If you have seven or 11 weeks, you can manage. But if you only have two or three weeks, the planning is completely different. I think India needs to take a step

Familiarity works: Even though it's not a common thing to share two coaching jobs, Marquez is confident because of his knowledge of Indian football and its players. ISL

forward because it's very important to know what will happen in the next [few months] in order to prepare for everything.

You have also spoken about Indian players being comfortable in India and not wanting to go abroad to play in other leagues. Have any players you've worked with approached you about pathways to get there?

I feel that this is more relevant to the next generation than the current one. Players aged 26-28 find it difficult to go abroad. There are very good young players in India between 17 and 21, which is a good age to go abroad because they have more opportunities to join academies rather than main teams. Some Indian players could play abroad. I don't know at which level, not in the top leagues, but they are indeed very comfortable here. Sometimes people get angry when I talk about this, but it's the reality.

Why are people angry about this?

They say, "You're always speaking about this." The salaries of Indian players are fantastic for them. If I were in their situation, I'd probably do the same. I'd stay here because it's home, with a good salary. Practically, I've secured my life, and that's okay. You could say it's a lack of ambition or just about the money, which is very important, but when the money is enough, I can try to go abroad. I can tell you, obviously, I won't tell you the names; some players in the national team and some at my clubs, FC Goa and Hyderabad FC before that, wanted to go abroad. But it's not easy. It's a pity because, when you play abroad and train with better players, your level improves. That's very good for you, for your future club, and for the national team. I don't like, for example, national teams that play